

The Carolina Journal

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...dance from Columbia.

That was all for the first set, so I kept on wandering. At the Chinese booth I found out that this is the Year of the Cock. Then I watched as a man wrote names in

Chinese. There were many items for sale at the booth like the dish decorated with dragons and the symbol I bought.

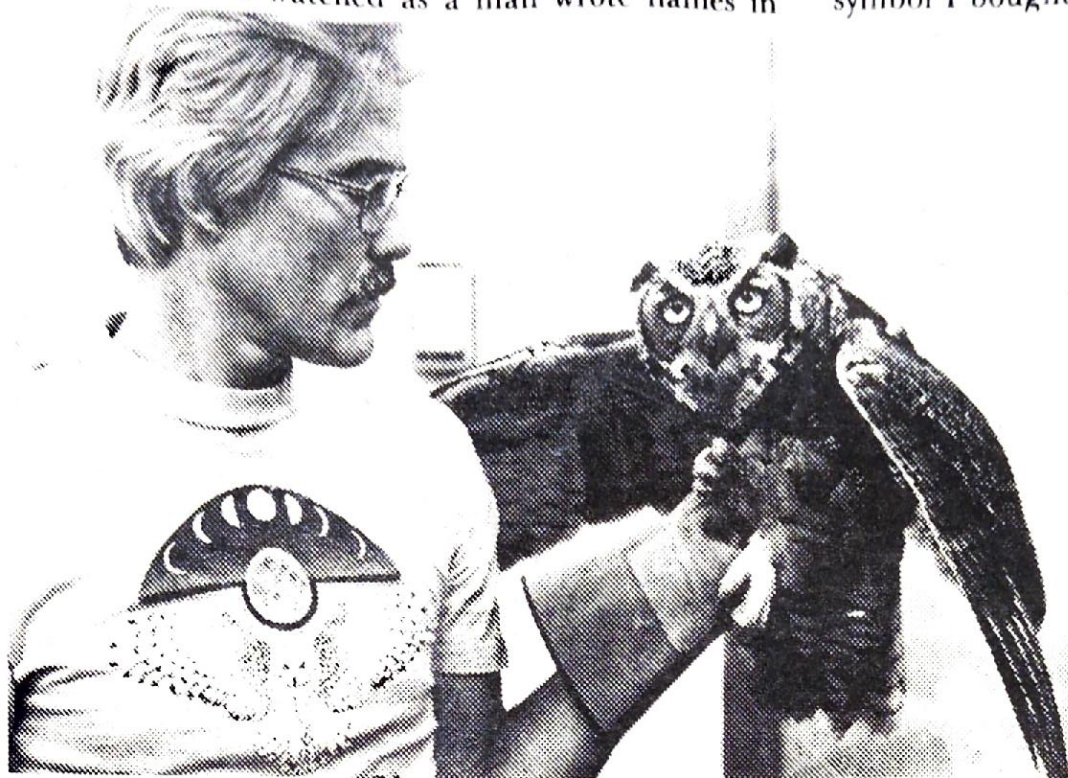


Photo by Ray Gronberg

Dr. Richard Brown and the owl, named Buboy

Owl's Psyche Blown

By Ray Gronberg
Carolina Journal News Editor

If you were attacked by an owl last week, you can rest assured that it was not trying to hurt you.

As a matter of fact, it probably thought you were its mother.

The bird, released on campus as part of a program to rehabilitate and release injured raptors, or birds of prey, was recaptured Thursday night after chasing several students and a campus police officer, according to Dr. Richard Brown, director of the Carolina Raptor Rehabilitation and Research Center (CRRRC), located in the basement of the McEniry Building.

Brown says the great horned owl, which came to the center after being on public display in Dan Nicholas State Park in Rowan County, suffers from an unusual problem. Captured while still young, it has "imprinted" on people, instead of on other owls, namely its parents.

"You're surrounded by people, they're the ones taking care of you and feeding you, so who are you going to go to for a handout," he explains.

The owl, Brown says, is almost too tame to exist in the wild.

"We first released it in Mooresville," he says. "A woman called shortly afterwards,

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Caravan Unth

Dr. Joseph Black, a retired widower, has a little to do on cold mornings, Black took the 14th tee at the Mountain Country Club, down bourbon and at the hard frost on his left foot. He put a bottle in the car, over and set up. Stepping back he club, took a few swings, addressed and drove it out of the fairway. Black forgot the flight of the ball, the clear blue horizon sky exploded. Black not see. The cold remains of his eyes from scorched so palms stung and he drop his golf club. It had melted on the grass. With an agonized Black fell into the grass.*

A number of along the east of mankind will never experience the scribed above, nuclear attack, are doing something it.

A caravan of asking for w

Employment Process are the subjects on Oct. 1. Leon J. Smith, a guest

speaker. This is an ideal time for undergraduates to learn about grad-

uate studies. The staff will be glad to discuss career plans and opportu-

nities. The Employment Center, "The Employment Process—Contacts and Interviews," Leon J. Smith

Owl

saying that the bird was sitting on someone's shoulder like it was a pet."

The problem now is to find some solution that would allow the bird to be released from captivity.

"Imprinting is known to be irreversible, so it's going to be a pain in the neck," Brown explains.

He says he will talk to some researchers in the Psychology department, in hopes of finding a new process to reverse the imprint. Failing in that, the owl will either be released in a remote area or be given to a zoo.

The latter would not make Brown very happy.

"It's our philosophy that birds that can fly and can exist in the wild should be left in the wild," he says.

The owl is one of 55 injured birds the CRRRC has handled this year. Most of them have broken limbs caused by gunshot wounds.

Some birds have had to have wings and other limbs amputated because of the severity of their injuries, which obviously means they can never return to the wild.

A hawk that came in earlier in the year, says Brown, had an infestation of maggots around a gunshot wound under one wing. It died in an hour.

"There's some that come in that there's not much you can do for," Brown says.

The main problem, he says, is that not enough people are aware of the fact that shooting a raptor (owls, hawks, falcons, eagles, vultures, etc.) or keeping one as a pet is illegal under state and federal laws.

He asks that people who know of instances where the law has been violated, or who have caught an injured or an orphaned bird, call the N.C. Wildlife Commission at 1-800-662-7137.

The commission refers

(Continued From Page 1)

cases of injured birds to the CRRRC, as it is the only organized effort of its type in the state.

Brown hopes the center will be able to expand its efforts in the future. Plans exist for a 10,820 square-foot building, complete with outdoor cages, to be built somewhere on campus.

However, such things cost money, in this case an estimated \$500,000. The center, financed entirely by donations, is underfunded as it is, Brown says.

Brown can be reached through the Biology department, ext. 2315.

(Continued From Page 1)

Caravan

arms freeze and an affirmation of U.S. commit-

is Oct. 13. The "Torch of Friendship" will arrive

Day of Concern.

The caravan is expected

York. UNCC students are